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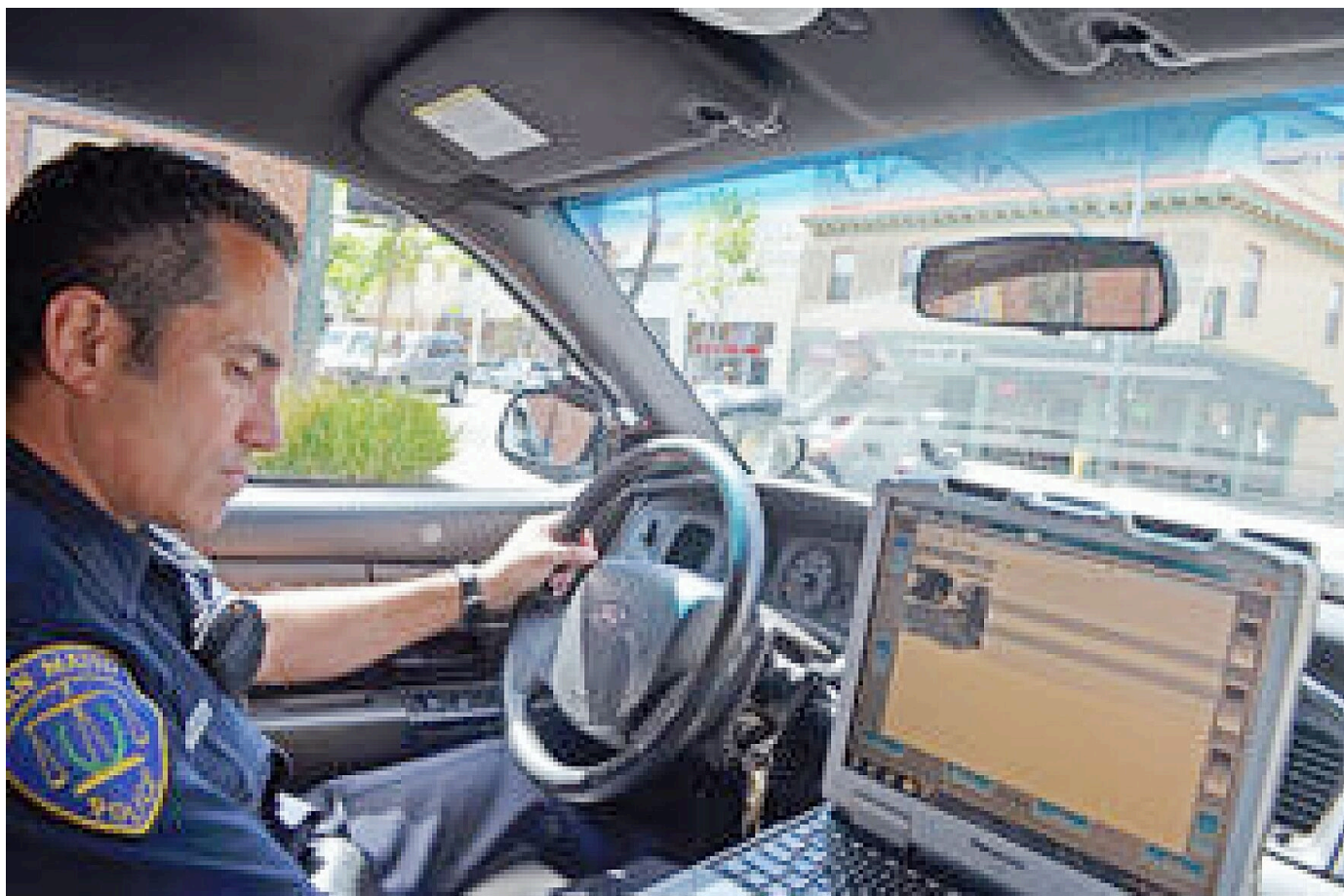
FEATURED

License plate readers to increase throughout county

Several Peninsula cities boost license plate reader programs, amid data-sharing concerns

By Alyse DiNapoli, Daily Journal staff

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San Mateo police Officer Shandon Murphy shows how the department's vehicle-mounted license plate reader scans and sends data to the Northern California Regional Intelligence Center.



Citing increases in organized retail theft, several cities throughout the county are purchasing more automated license plate readers, but rampant data-sharing violations among law enforcement agencies, both Bay Area and statewide, keep giving some residents pause.

A large shopping mall presence in each of their cities triggered a recent agreement between San Bruno, San Mateo and Daly City to boost ALPRs — which are computer-controlled camera systems often situated at traffic lights and intersections — and other cities, like Belmont, just decided to move forward on an ALPR program after taking a wait-and-see approach for several years.

alyse@smdailyjournal.com

(650) 344-5200 ext. 102

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